

Ciffiam Lozenges

VICIFxx-PC2 (FEO)

DESCRIPTION

Round, white uncoated lozenge with beveled edged and flat faces.

COMPOSITION

Each lozenge contains 3 mg Benzydamine Hydrochloride.

ACTIONS AND PHARMACOLOGY

Benzydamine is an anti-inflammatory analgesic agent structurally unrelated to the steroid group. Benzydamine differs chemically from other non-steroid anti-inflammatory agents in that it is a base rather than an acid.

In common with the aspirin-like drugs, benzydamine possesses an antipyretic activity.

The mechanism of anti-inflammatory action is not related to stimulation of the pituitary-adrenal axis. Like other nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory agents, benzydamine inhibits the biosynthesis of prostaglandins under certain conditions, but its properties in this respect have not been fully elucidated. The stabilising effect on cellular membranes may also be involved in the mechanism of action.

PHARMACOKINETICS

Absorption

Benzydamine is well absorbed following oral administration. Following topical administration of benzydamine hydrochloride in solution form, benzydamine is well absorbed into the inflamed oral mucosa where it exerts anti-inflammatory and local anesthetic actions. Plasma benzydamine levels following use of benzydamine orally are low and parallel the amount actually ingested.

Excretion

Benzydamine and its metabolites are excreted largely in the urine. Metabolism is largely by oxidative pathways, although dealkylation can be shown.

INDICATION

For the temporary relief of painful conditions of the oral cavity including tonsillitis, sore throat, radiation mucositis, aphthous ulcers, post-oral surgical and periodontal procedures, pharyngitis, swelling, redness and inflammatory conditions.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Patients with known hypersensitivity to benzydamine.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

If a sore throat is either caused or complicated by a bacterial infection, appropriate antibacterial therapy should be considered in addition to the use of Ciffiam Lozenges.

For use in patients with hepatic or renal see Dosage and Administration section.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Available data show no evidence of an increased occurrence of foetal damage.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

There are no known drug interactions with benzydamine.

MAIN SIDE/ADVERSE EFFECTS

Ciffiam Lozenges in topical oral preparations is generally well tolerated and side-effects are minor. The following adverse reactions have been reported after use of benzydamine hydrochloride in solution form:

Local Adverse Reactions: The most commonly reported reaction is oral numbness (2.6%). Occasional burning or stinging sensation may occur and has been reported in 1.4% of treated cases. Other local adverse effects were less common and included dryness or thirst (0.2%), tingling (0.2%), warm feeling in mouth and altered sense of taste (<0.1%).

Systematic Adverse Reactions: There were very uncommon and never of a serious nature. They consisted mainly of nausea, vomiting, retching, gastro-intestinal disorders (0.4%), dizziness (0.1%), headache and drowsiness (<0.1%).

Hypersensitivity reactions occur very rarely but may be associated with pruritis, rash, urticaria, photodermatitis and occasionally laryngospasm or bronchospasm.

OVERDOSAGE AND TREATMENT

There are no known cases of overdosage with Ciffiam Lozenges. Adverse CNS effects have been reported following overdosage with high doses of benzydamine hydrochloride in solution form. There is no specific antidote for benzydamine and should excessive quantities be ingested, the treatment should be symptomatic.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Oral administration.

Ciffiam Lozenges should not be chewed.

It should be slowly dissolved in the mouth.

One lozenge should be sucked slowly very one to two hours as required up to a maximum of 12 lozenges per day.

Uninterrupted treatment should not exceed 7 days.

With Impaired Renal Function: Since absorbed benzydamine and its metabolites are excreted in the urine, the possibility of systematic effects should be considered in patients with severe hepatic impairment.

With Impaired Liver Function: Since absorbed benzydamine is highly metabolized in the liver the possibility of systematic effects should be considered in patients with severe hepatic impairment.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information, consult your doctor or pharmacist.

Storage: Store below 30°C.

Presentation/ Packing: Blisters of 1 x 6's, 3 x 6's

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